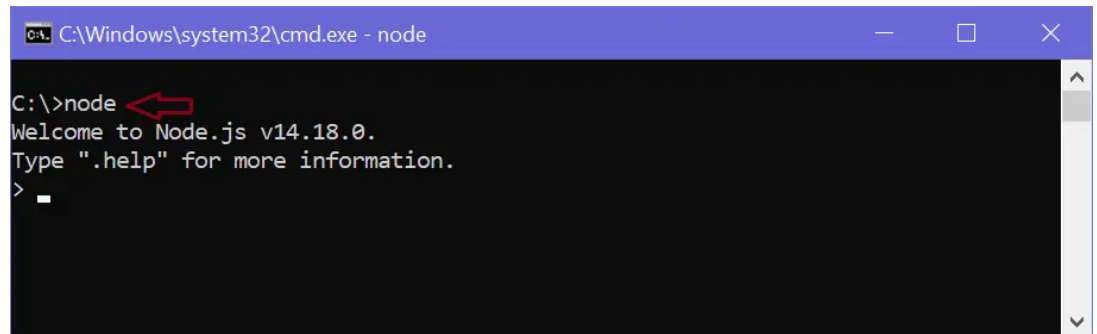


Node.js Console/REPL

Node.js comes with virtual environment called REPL (aka Node shell). REPL stands for Read-Eval-Print-Loop. It is a quick and easy way to test simple Node.js/JavaScript code.

To launch the REPL (Node shell), open command prompt (in Windows) or terminal (in Mac or UNIX/Linux) and type *node* as shown below. It will change the prompt to *>* in Windows and MAC.

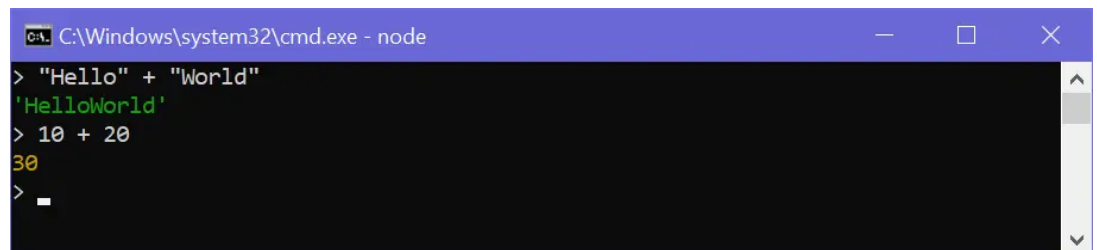


```
C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe - node
C:\>node
Welcome to Node.js v14.18.0.
Type ".help" for more information.
>
```

Launch Node.js REPL

You can now test pretty much any Node.js/JavaScript expression in REPL. $10 + 20$ will display 30 immediately in new line.

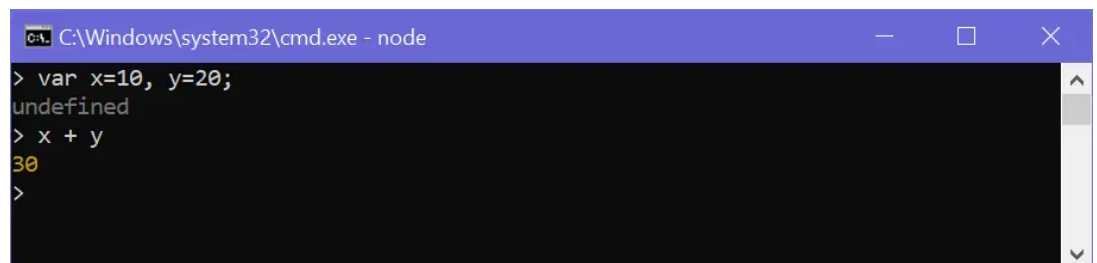
The $+$ operator also concatenates strings as in browser's JavaScript.



```
C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe - node
> "Hello" + "World"
'HelloWorld'
> 10 + 20
30
>
```

Node.js Examples

You can also define variables and perform some operation on them.

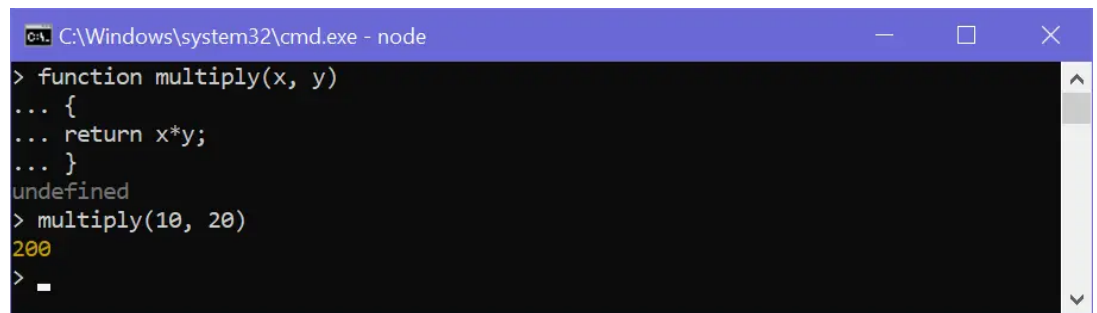


```
C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe - node
> var x=10, y=20;
undefined
> x + y
30
>
```

Define Variables on REPL

If you need to write multi line JavaScript expression or function then just press **Enter** whenever you want to write something in the next line as a continuation of your code. The REPL terminal will display three dots (...), it means you can continue on next line. Write *.break* to get out of continuity mode.

For example, you can define a function and execute it as shown below.



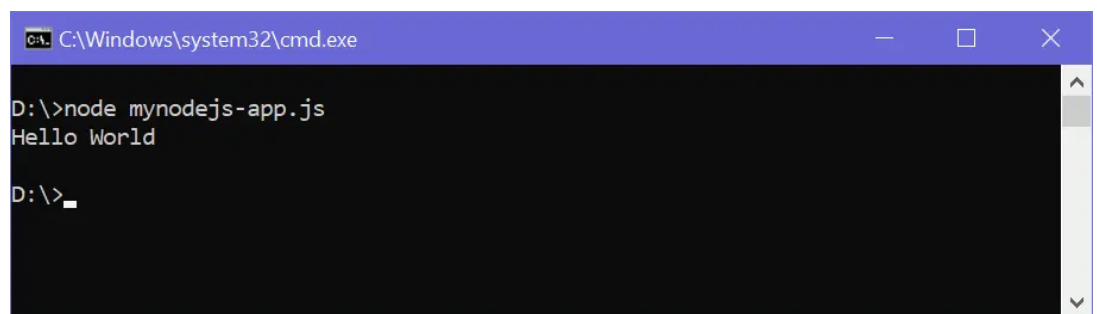
```
C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe - node
> function multiply(x, y)
... {
... return x*y;
... }
undefined
> multiply(10, 20)
200
>
```

Node.js Example in REPL

You can execute an external JavaScript file by executing the `node fileName` command. For example, the following runs `mynodejs-app.js` on the command prompt/terminal and displays the result.

mynodejs-app.js	Copy
console.log("Hello World");	

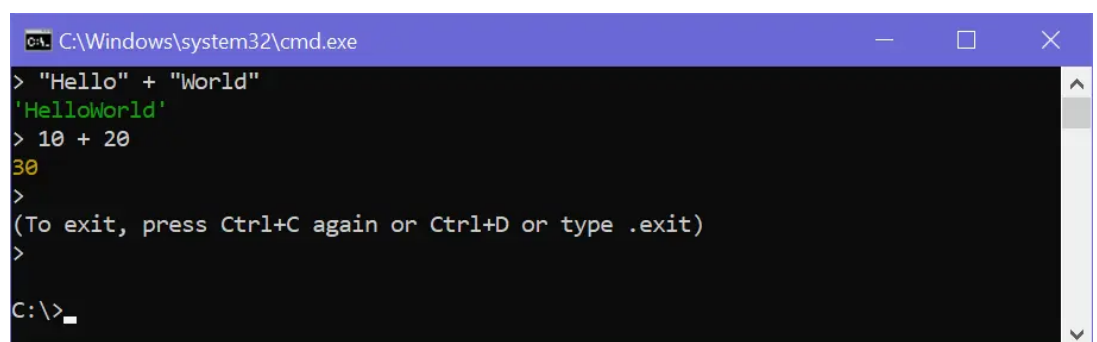
Now, you can execute `mynodejs-app` from command prompt as shown below.



```
C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe
D:\>node mynodejs-app.js
Hello World
D:\>
```

Run External JavaScript file

To exit from the REPL terminal, press Ctrl + C twice or write `.exit` and press Enter.



```
C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe
> "Hello" + "World"
'HelloWorld'
> 10 + 20
30
>
(To exit, press Ctrl+C again or Ctrl+D or type .exit)
>
C:\>
```

Quit from REPL

Thus, you can execute any Node.js/JavaScript code in the node shell (REPL). This will give you a result which is similar to the one you will get in the console of Google Chrome browser.

The following table lists important REPL commands.

--	--

.help	Display help on all the commands
tab Keys	Display the list of all commands.
Up/Down Keys	See previous commands applied in REPL.
.save filename	Save current Node REPL session to a file.
.load filename	Load the specified file in the current Node REPL session.
ctrl + c	Terminate the current command.
ctrl + c (twice)	Exit from the REPL.
ctrl + d	Exit from the REPL.
.break	Exit from multiline expression.
.clear	Exit from multiline expression.

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